

Driver Launch, Posture, Transfer & Low Point

Driver launch work now leads the card: launch weeks 1–8, speed weeks 1–12, on separate days.
Irons and short game continue underneath. If the week collapses, keep the launch block and the speed sticks.

01 Driver — launch first, speed second

THE PROBLEM IN ONE LINE

Spin loft of 9.1° with a 10.5° head means you are *delofting* the driver at impact. The 5 wood delivers 13.2° of spin loft and out-carries the driver by 6.5 m on 5.7 mph less ball speed.

Baseline — 63-shot slice, 6 May + 4 Jul 2026, n=15 drivers

METRIC	BASELINE	METRIC	BASELINE	METRIC	BASELINE
Club speed	85.4 mph	Dynamic loft	9.9°	Peak height	8.3 m
Ball speed	127.7 mph	Spin loft	9.1°	Landing angle	16.7°
Smash	1.495	Launch	8.6°	Carry	143.0 m
Attack angle	+0.8°	Spin	1862 rpm	Total	177.2 m

WHY LAUNCH IS THE PRIORITY, NOT SPEED

Within these 15 drives, carry correlates with launch at 0.77 and with spin at 0.65, but with club speed at only 0.51. The longest drive of the set — 182.6 m — was the highest-spin, highest-launch one. Not the fastest. Speed still runs in parallel, because it is cheap and it compounds, but it is the second lever here and it should be treated like one.

A0 — equipment changes, before drill one

These are free yardage and they change the numbers you will be training against, so make them first.

- Loft up the hosel.** Elyte OptiFit — 10.5° to 11.5°, or 12° if it is available. Worth roughly 1° of dynamic loft and 150–200 rpm immediately, for the price of two minutes with the wrench.
- Tee height.** Tee so the equator of the ball sits level with the crown — about half the ball above the top line. You are most likely teeing at iron-ish height, which makes an ascending strike physically awkward before the swing even starts.
- Ball position.** Off the lead heel — genuinely forward, not "forward for you". Put an alignment stick on the ground perpendicular to the target line at your lead heel for the first three sessions and stop guessing.
- Ball model — test, do not assume.** TP5 sits on the low-spin end of the market and spin is exactly what you are short of. Put a sleeve of Pro V1 or Chrome Soft in the bag for one Trackman session and compare driver spin directly. Keep whichever wins. Never change ball model and swing pattern in the same session.

RE-BASELINE BEFORE YOU START A1

Take a fresh Trackman baseline *after* those four changes. The equipment alone may move launch 1.5–2° and spin 300 rpm, and you want to train against the real remaining gap rather than against a number the wrench already fixed.

DA Launch conditions — weeks 1–8

Two sessions a week, never on a speed day. The gates at the end of this block decide when you move phase, not the calendar.

A1 — weeks 1–3: build the ascending strike

GOAL

Attack angle from +0.8° to **+2.5°**, without losing centre-face contact. Strike location is still a constraint here, not a free variable.

DRILL	REPS	WHAT IT FIXES
Tilt-and-hold setup No ball. Add 5–8° of trail-side spine tilt so the lead shoulder sits visibly higher, about 55% of your weight on the trail foot. Hold five seconds.	10	Installs the position at address instead of asking the swing to find it. This is a setup, not a swing thought.
Forward-tee gate Second tee pushed nearly flush into the turf 20 cm ahead on the target line. The clubhead must miss it. Start at 60% effort.	15	Attack angle, with immediate binary feedback. Clipping the tee means you are still descending.
Step-through finish Full swing, then let the trail foot walk through past the lead foot after impact.	10	Pivot moves left while the club exits up — the opposite of the early-extension pattern. If you cannot walk through, you stalled and stood up.
Half-speed loft rehearsal 50% effort, trying to see the ball launch visibly higher than normal. Ignore direction entirely.	10	Calibrates a feel rather than producing shots. A high pull counts as a success.

Session shape: 45 balls, about 35 minutes, twice a week. Never on a speed day.

A2 — weeks 4–6: add dynamic loft

GOAL

Dynamic loft from ~10° to **14°**, spin loft to ~11.5°. Attack angle alone will not get you there — raising AoA *reduces* spin loft, so dynamic loft has to climb faster than attack angle does. This is the phase where the block is actually won or lost.

DRILL	REPS	WHAT IT FIXES
Handle-back impact feel The feel is that the grip end has not run ahead of the clubhead at impact. Exaggerate it — try to feel the clubhead passing the hands before the ball.	12	Dynamic loft directly. It will feel like a scoop and it will not be one — check on Trackman, never by feel.
High-window shots Pick a tree or a point on the range netting and launch the ball over it.	15	Height is the only success criterion. Where the ball finishes is not information today.
Trail-hand-only swings No ball, half speed, trail hand alone on the club.	10	Stops the trail wrist flattening early into shaft lean — the move that quietly deletes your dynamic loft.
Numbers-up full swings Standing where you can see launch angle after every shot. Target 12°+. Say the number out loud before you look.	15	Builds the feel-to-real map. Without this the other three drills stay guesses.

Session shape: 40 balls plus rehearsals, about 40 minutes, twice a week.

A3 — weeks 7–8: consolidate under pressure

DRILL	REPS	WHAT IT FIXES
Nine-shot gate test One ball at a time, full pre-shot routine, 60 seconds between.	9	Your scoring drill for the block. Pass = 6 of 9 at launch $\geq 12^\circ$ and spin ≥ 2200 rpm.
Alternating clubs Driver, 5 wood, driver, 5 wood.	12	The 5 wood already delivers what you want. You are borrowing its feel — notice what changes between the two and take the difference back.
Course-sim tee shots Each ball to a different imagined fairway width, alternating targets. No swing thoughts allowed.	10	Tests whether the pattern survives a routine and a target. If it survives this, it survives the first tee.

GATES — THESE GOVERN THE PHASES, NOT THE DATES

Do not advance A1 → A2 until attack angle averages $\geq +2.0^\circ$ across a 10-shot benchmark. Do not advance A2 → A3 until spin is ≥ 2200 rpm on 6 of 10. A phase that has not passed its gate is not finished, however many sessions it has had.

BLOCK D-B

DB Speed training — weeks 1–12

Separate days from the launch block. Three sessions a week, non-consecutive, about 25 minutes. **Speed days are speed days** — no ball flight analysis, no swing thoughts, no scoring.

EQUIPMENT

A graduated speed-stick set — SuperSpeed or equivalent, light / medium / heavy. If you would rather not buy one: an alignment stick works as the light implement and an upside-down driver gripped at the hosel as the medium, but the progression is much cruder and the results will be too.

WARM-UP — SIX MINUTES, NON-NEGOTIABLE

Arm circles, trunk rotations, hip openers, then ten slow half-swings with the medium stick building to 60%. Overspeed work on cold tissue is how people injure ribs and lower backs. If anything hurts, stop the session — not just the set.

Weeks 1–3 — baseline protocol

SET	IMPLEMENT	REPS
1	Light	6 dominant, 6 non-dominant
2	Medium	6 dominant, 6 non-dominant
3	Heavy	6 dominant, 6 non-dominant
4	Driver	3 swings, full effort, no ball

The non-dominant reps are most of where the neuromuscular gain comes from. Do not skip them because they feel silly.

Progression

BLOCK	CHANGE
Weeks 4–6 add instability	Sets 1 and 2 become step-change swings : feet together, step into the lead foot during transition, swing through. Set 3 stays standard.
Weeks 7–9 add kneeling work	Sets 1 and 2 from both knees on a mat. Removes the ground push and forces the upper body to generate speed. Set 3 standard, set 4 goes to five driver swings.
Weeks 10–12 max effort	Full protocol, every rep at genuine maximum. Add a fifth set: five driver swings with a ball at full speed, accepting whatever happens to the ball. Record club speed on all five.

MEASUREMENT

Record max club speed on the **light stick, dominant hand, set 1 rep 6** every session. That is your speed metric. Do not use driver speed on the range as the tracking number — it is contaminated by whatever the launch block is doing to your swing that week.

02 Driver targets & checkpoints

Benchmark on Trackman every two weeks: ten drivers, full routine, log everything below.

METRIC	BASELINE	WEEK 4	WEEK 8	WEEK 12	ACTUAL
Attack angle	+0.8°	+2.0°	+3.0°	+3.5°	
Dynamic loft	9.9°	12.0°	14.0°	15.0°	
Spin loft	9.1°	10.5°	11.5°	12.5°	
Launch	8.6°	11.0°	12.5°	13.5°	
Spin	1862	2100	2300	2450	
Peak height	8.3 m	14 m	19 m	22 m	
Landing angle	16.7°	26°	33°	37°	
Club speed	85.4	86.5	88.0	90.0	
Carry	143 m	165 m	182 m	195 m	

EXPECTED SPLIT OF THE GAIN

Roughly **45–50 m from launch conditions** and 12–18 m from speed. If after week 8 the carry number has barely moved while launch and spin are on target, the problem is elsewhere — that is a fitting conversation, not a reason for more reps.

Caveats — what this data does not say

CAVEAT	WHY IT MATTERS
The 5 wood comparison is thin	Five shots across two sessions. Treat the 4.0 mph speed gap as directional, not as a measurement.
Spin may be estimated, not measured	If any of the baseline shots are virtual-range strokes, check the <i>reducedAccuracy</i> flag on the slice before treating 1862 rpm as gospel. If spin is estimated, re-baseline on a real range or a radar-confirmed session before committing to the A0 loft change.
This block works <i>with</i> your existing pattern	Early extension → low point behind the ball → thin high-face strikes. An ascending strike actually wants the low point behind the ball; what it does not want is the shaft lean. Watch that A1 does not quietly reintroduce early extension as a way of getting the ball higher.
Face-to-path stays closed — leave it	It is the smaller lever, and the two fixes interfere with each other. Launch first; revisit the face at week 12 with a clean baseline.

03 Read this before you hit anything

WHERE YOU ARE NOW — READ THIS BEFORE THE DIAGNOSIS BELOW

Over the top is resolved and the low point has moved forward. Those were the two hardest items on this card. What remains is confirmation on grass and a wrist flinch — a materially smaller job than the one this plan started with. The chain below is kept as reference for *why* the faults clustered, not as a current description of your swing.

Toe strikes, missing divots, chipping fat and the pull-hook are one fault wearing four costumes. Your lead leg pushes up too early, your whole body rises, and everything downstream is a consequence.

THE CHAIN

Lead leg extends early → body rises → swing radius shortens → clubhead arrives closer to you and higher on the face → **toe strike, thin, low point behind the ball** → hands flip to rescue it → face closes to path → **pull-hook**

Your own numbers sit on this chain exactly. Trackman confirmed toe-down delivery. Your best 5-iron was a centre strike at −3.2 face-to-path; the worst was a high-face thin at +11.9. The face only misbehaves once the strike already has. **Work at the front of the chain and the rest resolves without being addressed directly.**

THE NUANCE THAT MATTERS MOST

Lead leg extension is *not* the fault. Good players push hard off the lead leg — it is where speed comes from. The difference is direction: their pelvis moves **back and away from the ball line** while the chest stays down over the ball. Yours is thrusting **toward** the ball. At 87 mph you cannot spare the leg drive. Redirect it, never kill it.

Confirm it in sixty seconds

Set up with your glutes touching a wall or the back of a chair. Make slow swings. If your backside loses contact on the way down, that is early extension. Film it down-the-line if you want it on record.

Free check while you are there

With a 7-iron at address, arms hanging, you want roughly **one hand-width between the butt of the grip and your lead thigh**. Standing too far from the ball produces toe strikes on its own, with no swing fault required.

HOLD OFF ON THIS

Do not bend the P790 lie angles yet. Toe-down delivery caused by early extension will change once the posture does, and you would be fitting the clubs to a fault you are in the middle of removing. Revisit at week eight.

04 Keeping the blocks apart

Irons want low point **ahead** of the ball. The driver wants it **behind** — you are hitting up on a teed ball. Carrying the iron feel to the tee is a large part of how a 10.5° head ends up delivering 9.9° of dynamic loft and 1862 rpm.

Three separations, in order of how much they cost you when you get them wrong:

1. **Launch work and speed work never share a day.** Overspeed swings leave nothing for a fine-motor change, and the two intents pull in opposite directions — one wants precision at 60% effort, the other wants abandon at 100%.
2. **Iron low point and driver launch never share a twenty-minute block.** Separate them with a break and a rehearsal swing that resets the feel. If a session has to hold both, irons first, driver after the break.
3. **Ball model and swing pattern never change in the same session.** Two variables, no information.

A closed face is also a delofted face, so some of the missing spin is face-to-path rather than the head. It is still not this block's job — see the caveats on page 4. Launch is the larger lever and the two fixes interfere with each other.

05 Kit

Irons and short game: athlete's foot spray or line powder (divot start line *and* face strike location) · a chair or wall · chalk line or two alignment sticks · one towel · one headcover · phone on a stand for down-the-line video.

Driver block: the OptiFit wrench · a bag of tees you can push flush into the turf · a graduated speed-stick set, light / medium / heavy · a mat or soft ground for the kneeling sets · one sleeve each of Pro V1 and Chrome Soft for the ball test · a booked Trackman bay every two weeks, which is the only place this block gets scored.

06 Your practice swing already works

A rehearsal that bottoms out correctly is the best news on this card. **You are not missing a movement — you own it.** The ball takes it away from you. That changes the job entirely: not "learn a new pattern" but "stop the ball from triggering the old one," and the two need completely different practice. What the ball does is turn a swing *through* a space into a hit *at* an object. Your brain re-aims the whole motion at the ball as an endpoint rather than a waypoint, grip pressure spikes, the body slows to steer, and the hands take over to save it. That produces the early bottom and the flip precisely as you see them.

First, verify it honestly — the rehearsal divot test

Five practice swings on turf, **at real speed**, somewhere the marks show. Look at where they start relative to where a ball would sit.

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS
Marks start clearly ahead of the ball position	The pattern is genuinely there. Your problem is purely transfer — work the protocol below and expect fast progress.
Marks start behind, or the club barely brushes	The rehearsal is just slower and less committed. "It feels fine" is an illusion, and Blocks A–C still need the full mechanical work.

Most people land between the two. Be honest here — it decides where your eight weeks go.

THE TRANSFER PROTOCOL — GOVERNS EVERY BLOCK ON THIS CARD

1. Rehearsal and shot are one unit. Rehearse, step in, hit within five seconds. No re-setting, no re-gripping, no waiting.

2. Same speed both times. If the rehearsal is slower, it is not a rehearsal.

3. Look at a spot 10 cm ahead of the ball, or at its front edge. Never the back of it. Where you look is where the club wants to bottom out.

4. Grip pressure four out of ten — and check it is still four at the top.

5. Cut your time over the ball. Long deliberation is rising tension, and tension is how the ball wins.

6. **Score the swing, not the shot.** Rate every ball 1–5 on how close it felt to the rehearsal, and ignore where it went. Hardest rule here, and the one that matters most.

BLOCK A — ROOT CAUSE

A Posture retention & ball transfer

This is now the first block of every session and the only one that is never cut. Face spray goes on every fifth shot — **strike location is the scoreboard here, not ball flight.**

DRILL	REPS	WHAT IT FIXES
Chair drill Glutes against a chair back. The lead glute should <i>press into it</i> through impact, not leave it. Twenty slow rehearsals, then ten with a ball.	20 + 10	The root move. Teaches the pelvis to go back and away instead of toward the ball.
Heel-bias exaggeration Deliberately try to strike the heel side of the face. Spray the face every five shots.	20	You will land in the middle. For strike location, exaggeration beats caution every time.
Lead heel planted Half shots <i>keeping</i> the lead heel down throughout. Feel the hip clearing <i>rotationally</i> rather than jumping. Add speed back gradually.	15	Separates rotation from vertical thrust. This is the feel you are trying to keep.
Setup distance audit One hand-width, grip butt to lead thigh, arms hanging. Check before every drill.	every session	Removes the free toe strikes that have nothing to do with your swing.
Down-the-line video One clip per session, same angle, same spot. Draw a line down your backside at address.	1	Early extension is almost impossible to feel accurately. You need to see it.
Continuous swing Pendulum back and forth without ever stopping. On the third pass, a ball happens to be in the way.	10	Removes the setup-and-freeze ritual, which is where the tension builds.
Tee-only ladder Ten swings at a bare tee in the ground, then ten at a teed ball, then ten off turf.	30	Reintroduces the ball in stages instead of all at once.
Eyes closed Half shots, eyes shut once you are set. Yes, really.	10	Kills visual fixation and outcome steering outright. Strike usually improves immediately.
Swish past the ball Club turned upside down. The loudest swish must happen <i>past</i> where the ball would be.	15	Attacks the deceleration directly. You cannot steer and accelerate at the same time.

Graduation: when face spray shows the strike pattern centred and no longer drifting toward the toe across twenty shots, Block A drops to a ten-minute warm-up rather than a full block.

BLOCK B

B Chipping low point

Setup baseline, every session: narrow stance, feet slightly open, ball just back of centre, handle 2–4 cm ahead, seventy percent of pressure in the lead foot — and it *stays* there through the strike.

DRILL	REPS	WHAT IT FIXES
Line drill Chalk line on turf, ball sitting on it. The brush mark must start on or ahead of the line. Score every ball.	20	Direct low-point feedback. Your scoring drill for this block.
Lead-arm only Trail hand off entirely, 10 m chips.	15	Makes flipping physically impossible.
Towel behind Towel laid 10 cm behind the ball. Never touch it.	15	Kills the hang-back-and-scoop pattern.
Lead-foot only Trail toe on the ground for balance, nothing more.	15	Forces pressure forward early.
Freeze finish Normal chips. Hold the impact position three seconds and look at the shaft.	10	Builds the picture of what a forward low point actually feels like.

Graduation: at 16 of 20 on the line drill, add the **landing ladder** — three towels at 3, 6 and 9 m, five balls each, random order. Strike first, distance second.

c Low point confirmation

Steepness and safety are not the same thing. Margin for error comes from the low point sitting ahead of the ball, which you have already moved. A steeper delivery makes the bottom of the swing more V-shaped, so any error in low point position gets punished harder. A shallower, U-shaped bottom tolerates variation better. Shallow players typically have *better* distance control and *worse* performance from rough and bad lies. That is the real trade, and it is not a bad one to be on the wrong side of.

THE GOAL, RESTATED

Not a divot. **A mark after the ball, however shallow.** A bruise or a scuff of grass counts, and it means the low point is where you want it. If the club leaves nothing at all, the low point is still at or behind the ball. If it scuffs — you are done. Take the win and move on to the next shot.

MATS HAVE BEEN LYING TO YOU

On a mat, contact 2 cm behind the ball still produces a decent flight because the club skids into it. A mat cannot teach you low point and will actively mislead you here. **Every drill in this block happens on grass.**

The desensitisation ladder

The wrist flinch is the real obstacle, and it deserves respect rather than willpower. A flinch is not weakness and you will not override it by committing harder. **Move up a rung only when the current one is boring** — expect two or three sessions per rung. Going too fast rebuilds the fear you are trying to remove.

RUNG	DO THIS	WHY
1	Softest, dampest turf you can find. Short iron, half swings, <i>no ball</i> — just brush the grass. Twenty reps.	Turf contact with zero consequence attached.
2	Deliberate fat shots at 50% speed. Aim 3 cm behind the ball on purpose. Ten of them.	The key rung. Proves to your nervous system that turf contact does not hurt. Do not skip it.
3	Repeat rung 2 at 70%, then at 85%, across separate sessions.	Creeps the speed back without re-triggering the flinch.
4	Ball on a low tee on grass. Normal 9-iron shots, aiming to mark the turf past the tee.	Removes the fat-shot risk entirely while you practise marking turf.
5	Ball on turf. 9-iron, then 8, then 7. Check for a mark after every shot.	Normal golf, with the fear disarmed.

Two things throughout: grip pressure at four out of ten — a tight grip transmits shock straight into the wrists while a soft one absorbs it. And if wrist pain actually recurs, get it looked at rather than training through it. Pain rebuilds the flinch faster than any drill removes it.

Drills, once the ladder is done

DRILL	REPS	WHAT IT FIXES
Mark check Off grass. Log mark / no mark for every shot. 9-iron first, then 8, then 7.	10 each	Your scoring drill for this block. Binary, honest, and nothing to do with depth.
Line drill on grass Chalk line, ball sitting on it. The mark must start on or ahead of the line.	15	Confirms low point position without any reference to divot depth.
Punch shots Waist-high back, chest-high through, low flight.	10	Produces forward shaft lean, and reliably leaves a mark.
Step drill Feet together, step onto the lead foot as the club changes direction. 8-iron.	15	Pressure shift as a transition move rather than an afterthought.
Feet together Fuller swings with the feet touching.	10	Centres the strike and exposes balance loss.

BEFORE BLAMING YOUR SWING FOR SPIN

Check your 5-iron's actual loft. Strong-lofted distance irons often put a 5-iron at 23–24° — a traditional 4-iron — and hollow-body heads are low-spin by design. No swing change fixes that. The cheaper spin levers: clean grooves, a dry face and ball (a real factor in Finnish conditions), and centred strikes, since a centred hit spins meaningfully more than a toe strike. At roughly 75 mph club speed a long iron is never stopping quickly. Plan to run those in, and put your stopping-power expectations on the short irons and wedges.

07 The week

Five of these are driver days, and three of those are twenty-five minutes with a stick and no ball. Nothing here is long. What matters is that the launch days and the speed days stay separate.

SLOT	CONTENTS
Daily at home — 10 min	15 chair-drill rehearsals · 10 tilt-and-hold driver setups · 20 lead-arm-only chip swings · 10 step-drill rehearsals, no ball.
Mon — Speed, 25 min	Block D-B in full. No ball flight, no scoring, no swing thoughts. Log the light-stick number.
Tue — Driver launch, 45 min	Block A chair drill, 10 min → current launch phase in full (A1, A2 or A3).
Wed — Speed + short game, 55 min	Block D-B first, then Block B chipping and the landing ladder. Speed may share a day with the short game — never with launch work.
Thu — Irons, 50 min (grass only)	Block A warm-up, 10 min → Block C: current ladder rung, then the mark check → 10 balls to random targets.
Fri — Speed, 25 min	Block D-B in full. Third and last speed session of the week.
Sat — Driver launch, 45 min	Second launch session. Every second Saturday this becomes the Trackman benchmark: ten drivers, full routine, log the page-4 table.
Sun	Off, or short game only. Keeping the speed days non-consecutive is the one thing here not to improvise.

Phasing — twelve weeks, gated not dated

WEEKS	DRIVER	IRONS & SHORT GAME
Before wk 1	A0 equipment: loft up, tee height, ball position, ball test. Re-baseline on Trackman afterwards.	Carry on as you are. Nothing here waits for the driver.
1–3	A1 ascending strike, twice a week. Speed baseline protocol, three times a week.	Stage 1 — disarm. Ladder rungs 1–3 on grass, Block A as warm-up, no scoring.
4–6	A2 dynamic loft — the phase that decides the block. Speed adds step-change swings.	Stage 2 — confirm. Ladder rungs 4–5, then the mark check, logged honestly.
7–8	A3 consolidation: nine-shot gate test, alternating clubs, course-sim tee shots. Speed adds kneeling work.	Stage 3 — randomise. Never two of the same club in a row, one ball per target, played for a score.
9–12	Launch block is done — hold it with the A3 drills once a week. Speed goes to max effort.	Random practice throughout. Revisit lie angles and face-to-path now, on a clean baseline.

ON THE COURSE, FOR NOW

Take the divot question off the table entirely. Play the strike you have — your iron results are already good on average, and a shallow delivery is a legitimate way to play golf, not a fault to be fixed mid-round. The ladder belongs on the range. Trying to manufacture a divot on the course is exactly how you produce the duffs that started the flinch.

08

Scorecard — log weekly

METRIC	BASELINE	INTERIM	TARGET	ACTUAL — LOG BY DATE
Face strike, heel–toe spread (7-iron)	toe	centred	≤10 mm	
Face strike, height spread	22 mm	15 mm	≤10 mm	
Chair contact retained (out of 10 swings)	—	7	9	
Swing-match rating, average of 20 (1–5)	—	3.5	4.0+	
Shots paired to a rehearsal within 5 sec (of 20)	—	20	20	
Chip line drill, divot at/ahead of line (of 20)	—	15	18	
Turf mark after the ball, 9-iron off grass (of 10)	—	7	9	
Same, 7-iron off grass (of 10)	—	5	8	
Desensitisation ladder rung reached (1–5)	—	3	5	
Speed stick, light / dominant (mph)	—	every	every	
Launch sessions this week (of 2)	—	2	2	
Speed sessions this week (of 3)	—	3	3	

Iron carry distance is deliberately absent. It follows the strike, and tracking it now only tempts you into swinging harder at a fault you are still removing. Note also that centring a toe strike will add distance on its own, without a single mph of extra speed. Driver numbers are the exception and they live on page 4 — they are measured on Trackman every two weeks, not estimated on the range.

09 Traps

TRAP	WHY IT COSTS YOU
Scoring the shot instead of the swing	The single biggest trap for you. Judging by ball flight is exactly the outcome-focus that makes the ball hijack the swing in the first place. Rate the feel, walk away, look at the face spray later.
A 70% practice swing	A slower rehearsal bottoms out correctly for reasons that have nothing to do with your real swing. It flatters you and transfers nothing. Rehearse at full speed or do not count it.
Standing over the ball deliberating	Every extra second raises grip pressure and re-aims your intent at the ball. Short routine, commit, go.
Trying to stop the lead leg from extending	The most common overcorrection, and it kills speed you cannot spare at 87 mph. The leg should still push hard — the pelvis just travels back and away rather than toward the ball.
Standing closer to the ball to cure toe strikes	Treats the symptom and usually makes early extension worse, because you now have even less room for the arms. Set the one hand-width distance and leave it alone.
Bending the lie angles now	You would be fitting the irons to a delivery you are actively changing. Retest at week eight, then decide.
Chasing divot depth	Depth is a by-product of your natural angle of attack, not a skill. A shallow player who marks the turf after the ball has a correct strike. Judging yourself on how much earth flies is a fast route back to the chopping motion you just removed.
Practising low point on mats	The club skids, so contact well behind the ball still flies acceptably. Mats will tell you the problem is solved when it is not. Grass only for Block C.
Blaming your swing for iron spin	Check the loft on the club first. A 23° hollow-body "5-iron" at 75 mph will not stop quickly no matter what your delivery looks like.
Pushing through wrist pain	Discomfort during the ladder is expected; pain is not. One painful session will rebuild the flinch faster than a month of drills removes it.
Trying to "hit down" by chopping	Steepening the shaft with the hands moves low point <i>backwards</i> and produces exactly the fat-and-thin pattern you already have. The move is pressure and rotation, never arms.
Holding shaft lean rigidly	Freezing the wrists to prevent the flip kills clubhead speed and face control at once. Let the corrected low point remove the flip for you.
Mixing launch work and speed work	They never share a day. Overspeed swings leave nothing for a fine-motor change, and the two intents pull in opposite directions.
Driver work when tired	Early extension and the closed face both worsen under fatigue, and a tired ascending strike turns into a stand-up. Skip the session rather than train the pattern you are removing.
Getting the ball up by standing up	Early extension is a cheap way to add height and it costs you strike and speed. Loft comes from the clubface, not from the pelvis. This is the specific way the launch block can go wrong.
Chasing face-to-path this block	It stays closed in the data and it is the smaller lever. Launch first — the two fixes interfere with each other. Revisit at week 12.
Using range driver speed as the speed number	It is contaminated by whatever the launch block is doing that week. Track the light stick, dominant hand, set 1 rep 6, and nothing else.
Overspeed swings on cold tissue	Six minutes of warm-up, every session, no exceptions. Ribs and lower backs are how people pay for skipping it.
Skipping the non-dominant reps	They feel silly and they are where most of the neuromuscular gain lives.
Changing ball and pattern at once	Two variables, no information. Test the ball on its own session and keep whichever wins.
All block practice, never random	Weeks 1–4 genuinely need repetition. But if you never randomise, none of it survives contact with the first tee.
Letting soft Muurame turf flatter you	Wet ground lets a slightly fat strike still go somewhere respectable. Judge the divot start and the face spray, not the result.

IF YOU ONLY REMEMBER TWO LINES

The toe strike, the missing divot and the pull-hook are all the same fault — keep the backside back and you are working on all three at once.

And on the tee: **you are not short of speed, you are short of loft.** The ball goes up before it goes far.